

What the System Remembers: The Decision

系统记住了什么：决定

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The decision was made in the **basement** of the lab, in a room with a **mop** in the **corner** and a **full row** of boxes on the shelf. “We **begin** with **less** and **add more** only when the **term** is clear,” Maya said. “That is the **deal**.” The board had asked for a second **version**, and the **preparation** for it took the whole **summer**.

The **technique** was to **cut** the form at the centre and **reduce** it to one page. A **guide** for the staff, a **layer** of plain language over every field, and an **exclusive cycle** of review were the whole scheme. “**Count** the steps a person has to take,” she said. “That number is the **scale** of our respect.”

The **smell** of coffee and the **smell** of burnt dust came up from the pipes; the **transmission** of a report from the **top** floor was interrupted twice. “The **trend** is **linear** and the **probability** is not,” the analyst said, with **caution**. “A **tremendous burst** of enthusiasm is not **continuity**.”

The **justification** for every line had to be written beside it. “Do not **organize** the fields by department,” Lin said. “**Organize** them by the question a person asks.” A **roller** of tape, a **footprint** of mud by the door, and a **modifier** that changed the meaning of a sentence: the details of a serious redesign.

The **jump** from four fields to one was the hardest part. “We cannot **interrupt** the launch forever,” the director said. “A board will not watch a **disintegration** in slow motion.” He was right, and the group had to put the decision in writing by the next session.

The **scene** they agreed on was quiet: enter the room, look at the board, and start with the smallest **version**. If the nation wanted **more**, it would have to say so in the language of the form itself. The **center** of the argument was easy to see from the side of the room: the pattern would not change unless they intensified the pressure, and a large drop in the number of fields would include nothing but the essentials. A war of memos had already begun. The view from the **basement** was short, but the pattern was clear.

中文翻译

决定是在实验室的地下室做出的，房间里角落立着一把拖把，架子上整整齐齐一排箱子。“我们以更少开始，只有当术语清楚了才增加更多，”曼雅说，“这就是约定。”董事会要求出第二版，而为此的准备花掉了整个夏天。

方法是把表格从中间切开，缩减到一页。一份给员工的指南、覆盖每个字段的一层平实语言，以及一个排他性的复审循环，就是整个方案。“数一数一个人要走多少步，”她说，“那个数字就是我们尊重的尺度。”

咖啡的气味和烧焦灰尘的气味从管道里涌上来；从顶层传来的一份报告被打断了两次。“趋势是线性的，而概率不是，”分析师谨慎地说，“一阵巨大的热情不是连续性。”

每一行的正当理由都必须写在它旁边。“不要按部门来组织字段，”林伟说，“按一个人会问的问题来组织。”一卷胶带、门口一个泥泞的脚印，以及一个改变句意的修饰语：这些就是一次严肃重设计的细节。

从四个字段跳到一个是难的部分。“我们不能永远中断发布，”主管说，“董事会不会看着一场慢动作的瓦解。”他说得对，而小组必须在下次会议之前把决定写成书面。

他们商定的场景很安静：进屋、看一眼板子，然后从最小的版本开始。如果这个国家想要更多，就得用表格自己的语言说出来。从房间的这一侧看，这场论证的中心很容易看清：除非他们加大压力，否则模式不会改变；而字段数量的大幅削减，将只包含必要的东西。一场备忘文件的战争已经开始了。从地下室看出去的视野很短，但模式是清楚的。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
more mə: POS: n	n. 更多; a. 多的, 程度较大的, 更大的; adv. 多, 更多, 进一步; [计] DOS外部命令:显示满屏后自动暂停,并显示:"-----" Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. English statesman who opposed Henry VIII's divorce from Catherine of Aragon and was imprisoned and beheaded
begin bɪ'ɡɪn POS: v	v. 开始; [计] 开始 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Israeli statesman (born in Russia) who (as prime minister of Israel) negotiated a peace treaty with Anwar
full fʊl POS: n	n. 全部, 完整; a. 充满的, 完全的, 丰富的, 完美的, 丰满的, 详尽的; adv. 完全地, 整整, 十分; vt. 把(衣服等) ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. beat for the purpose of cleaning and thickening; v. make (a garment) fuller by pleating or gathering; a. con
term tɜ:m POS: n	n. 术语, 专有名词, 期限, 学期, 任期, 条件, 价钱, 关系, 地位, 项, 界石; vt. 称, 呼; [计] 检索词; 项 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a word or expression used for some particular thing; n. a limited period of time; n. any distinct quantity c
add æd POS: vt	vt. 增加, 添加, 附带说明, 计算...总和; vi. 做加法, 积累而成, 增添; [计] 加法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make an addition (to); join or combine or unite with others; increase the quality, quantity, size or scope
less les POS: n	n. 较少, 较小; a. 少的, 小的; adv. 较少, 较小, 较差; [计] 最低成本估算与调度法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (comparative of 'little' usually used with mass nouns) a quantifier meaning not as great in amount or degr
cut kʌt POS: n	n. 切口, 割伤, 降低, 切, 割, 砍, 削, 伤口, 削减, 缩短, 删节, 通路; a. 经切割的, 缩减的; vt. 切, 割, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a share of the profits; n. (film) an immediate transition from one shot to the next; n. a trench resembling
center 'sentə POS: n	n. 中心, 中心点, 中锋; a. 中央的, 位在正中的; vt. 集中, 定中心; vi. 居中; [计] 居中; 中央 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an area that is approximately central within some larger region; n. a building dedicated to a particular ac
reduce rɪ'dju:s POS: vt	vt. 减少, 分解, 降低, 使衰退, 把...分解, 把...归纳; vi. 减少, 减肥, 缩小; [计] 缩小 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cut down on; make a reduction in; v. make less complex; v. bring to humbler or weaker state or condition; v. ...
deal di:l POS: n	n. 交易, 协定, 数量, 买卖, 松木板; vi. 处理, 应付, 做生意; vt. 分配, 发牌, 给予; [计] 发牌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a particular instance of buying or selling; n. a plank of softwood (fir or pine board); n. the type of treat
summer 'sʌmə POS: n	n. 夏季, 全盛时期; vi. 避暑, 过夏天; [计] 加法器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the warmest season of the year; in the northern hemisphere it extends from the summer solstice to the autu
top tɒp POS: n	n. 顶部, 顶端, 极点, 上面, 上部, 顶篷, 最高地位, 首位, 陀螺; a. 最高的, 顶上的, 头等的; vt. 盖, 加以顶, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the upper part of anything; n. the highest or uppermost side of anything; n. the first half of an inning; wh
scene si:n POS: n	n. 场, 情景, 镜头, 发生地点, 道具, 布景, 景色; [化] 现场 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the place where some action occurs; n. an incident (real or imaginary); n. a consecutive series of pictures
box bɒks POS: n	n. 盒子, 箱, 方框, 一巴掌; vt. 装...入盒中, 装箱, 打耳光; vi. 拳击; [计] 方框 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a (usually rectangular) container; may have a lid; n. private area in a theater or grandstand where a small
technique tek'ni:k POS: n	n. 技巧, 技术, 方法; [化] 工艺方法; 技巧 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a practical method or art applied to some particular task
version 'vɜ:ʒən POS: n	n. 一种描述, 版本, 译文; [计] 版本 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an interpretation of a matter from a particular viewpoint; n. something a little different from others of t
corner 'kɔ:nə POS: n	n. 角落, 转角, 窘境; vt. 迫至一隅, 垄断, 使陷入绝境; vi. 相交成角, 垄断; [计] 边角 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a place off to the side of an area; n. the point where two lines meet or intersect; n. an interior angle for
scale skeil POS: n	n. 刻度, 衡量, 比例, 比例尺, 数值范围, 等级, 规模, 天平, 秤, 鳞, 积垢; vt. 依比例决定, 攀登, 测量, 绘制, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an ordered reference standard; n. relative magnitude; n. the ratio between the size of something and a repre
count kaunt POS: vt	vt. 计算, 视为; vi. 计数; n. 计算, 合计, 计数, 伯爵; [计] 计数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the total number counted; n. the act of counting; reciting numbers in ascending order; n. a nobleman (in var

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
jump dʒʌmp POS: n	n. 跳跃, 跳动, 暴涨, 惊跳; vt. 跳跃, 跃过, 突升, 使跳跃; vi. 跳跃, 跳, 跳动, 暴涨; [计] 转移, 跳转 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden and decisive increase; n. (film) an abrupt transition from one scene to another; n. descent with a...
row rəu. rau POS: n	n. 排, 行, 街道, 划船, 吵闹; vt. 使成排, 划, 划船, 参加(赛船), 痛骂; vi. 划船, 划动, 争吵; [计] 行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an arrangement of objects or people side by side in a line; n. a long continuous strip (usually running hor...
organize 'ɔ:ɡənaɪz POS: vt	vt. 组织, 有机化, 给予生机; vi. 组织起来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to be structured or ordered or operating according to some principle or idea; v. bring order and orga...
guide ɡaɪd POS: n	n. 引导者, 导游, 指南, 路标; vt. 指导, 支配, 管理, 带领, 操纵; vi. 任向导; [计] 辅助线 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who shows the way by leading or advising; n. a structure or marking that serves to direct the motio...
trend trend POS: n	n. 趋势, 倾向, 走向; vi. 倾向, 转向; [计] 趋势 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a general direction in which something tends to move; n general line of orientation; n a general tendency to...
preparation 'prepe'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 准备, 预备, 预习; [化] 制剂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the activity of putting or setting in order in advance of some act or purpose; n. (music) a note that produ...
layer 'leɪə POS: n	n. 层, 产卵鸡, 放置者; vt. 分层堆积, 压植; [计] 层 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. single thickness of usually some homogeneous substance; n. a relatively thin sheetlike expanse or region ly...
cycle 'saɪkl POS: n	n. 周期, 循环, 自行车, 一段时间, 整套; vi. 循环, 轮转, 骑自行车; vt. 使循环, 使轮转; [计] 环路; 周期; 循环 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an interval during which a recurring sequence of events occurs; n. a series of poems or songs on the same t...
smell smel POS: n	n. 味道, 气味, 嗅觉, 嗅, 臭味, 气息; vt. 闻, 探出, 察觉, 发出...的气味; vi. 嗅, 散发气味, 发臭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sensation that results when olfactory receptors in the nose are stimulated by particular chemicals in...
tremendous tri'mendəs POS: a	a. 巨大的, 非常的, 可怕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s extraordinarily large in size or extent or amount or power or degree; that a whole civilization should be d...
burst bə:st POS: n	n. 破裂, 突发, 爆发; v. 爆裂, 突发, 充满; [计] 二进制位组; 字符组; 脉冲串 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sudden flurry of activity (often for no obvious reason); v. come open suddenly and violently, as if from...
exclusive ik'sklu:slv POS: a	a. 排外的, 独占的, 唯一的; [计] 独占的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a news report that is reported first by one news organization; s. not divided or shared with others; a. excl...
interrupt .ɪntə'rʌpt POS: vt	vt. 中断, 妨碍, 插嘴; vi. 打断; n. 中断; [计] 中断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a signal that temporarily stops the execution of a program so that another procedure can be carried out; v. ...
basement 'beɪsmənt POS: n	n. 地下室, 墙脚; [化] 地下室 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the lowermost portion of a structure partly or wholly below ground level; often used for storage; n. the gr...
transmission træns'mɪʃən POS: n	n. 传输, 传送, 变速器; [计] 传输 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of sending a message; causing a message to be transmitted; n. communication by means of transmitted...
justification 'dʒʌstɪfɪ'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 辩护, 证明正当, 释罪; [计] 调整 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something (such as a fact or circumstance) that shows an action to be reasonable or necessary; n. a stateme...
probability 'prəbe'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 可能性, 或然率, 几率, 概率; [化] 概率; 几率 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a measure of how likely it is that some event will occur; a number expressing the ratio of favorable cases...
continuity 'kɒntɪ'nju:ɪti POS: n	n. 连续性; [化] 连续性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. uninterrupted connection or union; n. a detailed script used in making a film in order to avoid discontinui...
caution 'ko:ʃən POS: n	n. 小心, 慎重, 警示; vt. 警告; [计] 警告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trait of being cautious; being attentive to possible danger; n. a warning against certain acts; n. judic...
linear 'lɪniə POS: a	a. 线的, 直线的, 线状的; [计] 线性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. designating or involving an equation whose terms are of the first degree; a. of or in or along or relating...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
intensify in'tensɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 加强; vi. 强化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make more intense, stronger, or more marked; v. become more intense; v. make the chemically affected part of...
roller 'rɒlə POS: n	n. 滚筒, 滚轴, 压路机; [化] 滚柱; 托辊 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a grounder that rolls along the infield; n. a long heavy sea wave as it advances towards the shore; n. a sma...
footprint 'fʊtprɪnt POS: n	n. 足迹; [计] 印迹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mark of a foot or shoe on a surface; n. a trace suggesting that something was once present or felt or oth...
mop mɒp POS: n	n. 拖把, 鬼脸; vt. 用拖把洗擦, 擦, 拭; vi. 做鬼脸; [计] 维护操作协议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cleaning implement consisting of absorbent material fastened to a handle; for cleaning floors; v to wash or...
disintegration dis.inti'greɪʃən POS: n	n. 瓦解; [化] 破碎; 崩解; 蜕变 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a loss (or serious disruption) of organization in some system
modifier 'mɒdɪfaɪə POS: n	n. 修正的人, 修饰语; [计] 修改量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a content word that qualifies the meaning of a noun or verb; n. a moderator who makes less extreme or uncom...